

Reasoning: Puzzle Test (Complete Study Guide)

Theory, 12 Solved Examples, and 25 Practice Questions with Answer Key

Part 1: Theory & Core Concepts

1. What is Puzzle Reasoning?

Puzzle Reasoning involves problems where multiple items, persons, professions, days, or attributes are given, and you are required to map or associate them correctly based on a set of logical clues or conditions.

2. Major Types of Puzzles

- **Floor / Box Puzzle:** Items or persons placed on different floors of a building or stacked boxes.
- **Scheduling / Days / Months / Years Puzzle:** Events happening on specific days of the week, months, or years.
- **Comparison / Ranking Puzzle:** Persons or items compared by height, weight, age, or marks.
- **Profession / Blood Relation Puzzle:** Assigning distinct professions, colors, or cities to different individuals.

3. Essential Solving Strategies

- **Note Down Definite Clues First:** Start with direct statements that contain fixed positions (e.g., "A lives on the topmost floor").
- **Use Possibility Cases:** If a clue gives two options, draw parallel cases and eliminate the incorrect one as you progress.
- **Create Matrix Tables:** For multi-variable puzzles, tabulate rows and columns to track relationships clearly.

Part 2: Solved Examples (12 Examples)

Example 1 (Floor Puzzle)

Data: 3 floors building (1 to 3, bottom to top). Three persons A, B, C live on these floors. C lives on an odd floor above floor 1 (i.e., Floor 3). A does not live on floor 3. Who lives on floor 2?

Solution: C lives on Floor 3. A does not live on Floor 3, so A must live on Floor 1 (since Floor 3 is taken). Remaining person B must live on Floor 2.

Answer: B

Example 2 (Days Puzzle)

Data: An event takes place on one of the three days: Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday. Physics test is on Monday. Chemistry is after Physics but not on Wednesday. When is Chemistry?

Solution: Physics is on Monday. Chemistry is after Monday but not Wednesday, so Chemistry must be on Tuesday.

Answer: Tuesday

Example 3 (Comparison Puzzle)

Data: Three persons P, Q, R have different heights. P is taller than Q. Q is taller than R. Who is the shortest?

Solution: Height order from tallest to shortest: $P > Q > R$. Therefore, R is the shortest.

Answer: R

Example 4 (Profession Puzzle)

Data: Three friends X, Y, Z are Doctor, Engineer, and Teacher. X is not a Doctor. Y is an Engineer. Who is the Doctor?

Solution: Y is Engineer. Since X is not Doctor, X must be Teacher. Remaining profession Doctor goes to Z.

Answer: Z

Example 5 (Box Puzzle)

Data: Three boxes 1, 2, 3 are stacked. Box 3 is at the bottom? Let's say Box 1 is at top, Box 3 is at bottom. Box 2 is between 1 and 3. Which box is in the middle?

Solution: Box 2 is explicitly stated or deduced to be between 1 and 3.

Answer: Box 2

Example 6 (Ranking Puzzle)

Data: In a test, M scored more than N. O scored less than N. P scored more than M. Who scored the highest?

Solution: Order from highest to lowest: $P > M > N > O$. P scored the highest.

Answer: P

Example 7 (Color Puzzle)

Data: Three cars Red, Blue, Green belong to A, B, C. A does not own Red. B owns Blue. Who owns Red?

Solution: B owns Blue. Since A does not own Red, A must own Green. Thus, Red belongs to C.

Answer: C

Example 8 (Month Puzzle)

Data: Exams are held in Jan, Feb, Mar. English exam is in Jan. Math is after English but not in March. When is Math?

Solution: English is in Jan. Math is after Jan and not March, so Math is in February.

Answer: February

Example 9 (Age Puzzle)

Data: Amit is older than Sumit. Sumit is older than Rohit. Who is the youngest?

Solution: Age order: Amit > Sumit > Rohit. Rohit is the youngest.

Answer: Rohit

Example 10 (Fruit Puzzle)

Data: Three persons like Apple, Banana, Mango. John likes Apple. Smith does not like Mango. David likes Mango. What does Smith like?

Solution: John likes Apple, David likes Mango. Smith cannot like Mango, so Smith must like Banana.

Answer: Banana

Example 11 (Floor Puzzle)

Data: 4 floors (1 to 4). D lives on top floor (4). C lives immediately below D. B lives on floor 1. Who lives on floor 2?

Solution: D is on 4. C is on 3 (below D). B is on 1. Remaining person A must live on floor 2.

Answer: A

Example 12 (City Puzzle)

Data: Three persons live in Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata. Ram does not live in Delhi. Shyam lives in Mumbai. Where does Ram live?

Solution: Shyam lives in Mumbai. Ram does not live in Delhi, so Ram lives in Kolkata (leaving Delhi for the third person).

Answer: Kolkata

Part 3: Practice Questions (25 Questions)

Q1. Three persons A, B, C live on floors 1 to 3 (3 is top). A lives on an even floor. B lives below A. Who lives on floor 1?

- (A) A (B) B (C) C (D) Cannot be determined

Q2. Four persons P, Q, R, S have different weights. P is heavier than Q. R is lighter than Q. S is heavier than P. Who is the heaviest?

- (A) P (B) Q (C) R (D) S

Q3. Events take place on Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday. Quiz is on Tuesday. Sports is immediately after Quiz. When is Sports?

- (A) Monday (B) Wednesday (C) Thursday (D) Tuesday

Q4. Three friends X, Y, Z like different colors: Red, Blue, Green. X does not like Red. Y likes Blue. What color does Z like?

- (A) Red (B) Blue (C) Green (D) Cannot be determined

Q5. Five boxes 1 to 5 are stacked. Box 3 is in the middle. Box 1 is at top. Box 5 is at bottom. Box 2 is above 3. Which box is immediately below Box 1?

- (A) Box 2 (B) Box 3 (C) Box 4 (D) Box 5

Q6. Three students M, N, O secured 1st, 2nd, 3rd ranks. M did not get 1st. N got 3rd. What rank did M get?

- (A) 1st (B) 2nd (C) 3rd (D) None

Q7. Four persons J, K, L, M were born in different years: 1990, 1992, 1995, 1998. J is oldest. M is youngest. K is older than L. Who was born in 1992?

- (A) J (B) K (C) L (D) M

Q8. Three professionals Baker, Painter, Singer are A, B, C. Baker is neither A nor B. Painter is C. Who is the Singer?

- (A) A (B) B (C) C (D) Cannot be determined

Q9. In a building of 4 floors (1 to 4), W lives on floor 3. X lives on an even floor. Y lives on floor 1. Who lives on floor 4?

- (A) W (B) X (C) Y (D) Z (Remaining person)

Q10. Three cars Swift, Alto, Nexon have different speeds. Swift is faster than Alto. Nexon is slower than Alto. Which car is slowest?

- (A) Swift (B) Alto (C) Nexon (D) None

Q11. Four friends E, F, G, H have different pets: Dog, Cat, Parrot, Rabbit. E has Dog. G has Parrot. F does not like Cat. What pet does H have?

- (A) Cat (B) Rabbit (C) Parrot (D) Dog

Q12. Three meetings take place in Jan, Feb, Mar. Meeting A is in Feb. Meeting B is before A. When is Meeting C?

- (A) January (B) February (C) March (D) April

Q13. Four persons A, B, C, D have heights: 150cm, 155cm, 160cm, 165cm. A is 160cm. B is taller than A. C is shortest. What is D's height?

- (A) 150cm (B) 155cm (C) 165cm (D) 160cm

Q14. Three sports Cricket, Football, Tennis are played by 3 boys. Cricket is played by Rahul. Sachin does not play Tennis. What does Sachin play?

- (A) Cricket (B) Football (C) Tennis (D) None

Q15. Five books P, Q, R, S, T are kept on a shelf. P is above Q. R is below Q. S is above P. T is below R. Which book is at the very bottom?

- (A) P (B) R (C) T (D) Q

Q16. Three brothers Alpha, Beta, Gamma have ages 20, 22, 25. Alpha is youngest. Gamma is oldest. What is Beta's age?

- (A) 20 (B) 22 (C) 25 (D) 21

Q17. Four cities Delhi, Agra, Jaipur, Mumbai are visited in sequence. Delhi is visited first. Mumbai is visited last. Agra is visited before Jaipur. When is Agra visited?

- (A) 2nd (B) 3rd (C) 4th (D) 1st

Q18. Three people X, Y, Z drink Tea, Coffee, Milk. X drinks Tea. Y does not drink Milk. What does Z drink?

- (A) Tea (B) Coffee (C) Milk (D) None

Q19. In a building of 3 floors, P lives on 1. Q lives above P. R lives above Q. Who lives on top floor?

- (A) P (B) Q (C) R (D) None

Q20. Four students scored marks: 40, 50, 60, 70. John scored 60. Smith scored less than John. David scored more than John. Who scored 70?

- (A) John (B) Smith (C) David (D) Cannot be determined

Q21. Three days are Mon, Tue, Wed. Test A is on Mon. Test B is not on Wed. When is Test B?

- (A) Monday (B) Tuesday (C) Wednesday (D) None

Q22. Three items Laptop, Tablet, Phone have prices. Laptop is costliest. Tablet is cheaper than Laptop but costlier than Phone. Which is cheapest?

- (A) Laptop (B) Tablet (C) Phone (D) None

Q23. Four friends wear shirts: White, Black, Blue, Red. A wears White. B wears Blue. C does not wear Black. What does D wear?

- (A) Black (B) Red (C) Blue (D) White

Q24. Three persons M, N, O have weights 50kg, 55kg, 60kg. M is 50kg. O is heavier than N. What is O's weight?

(A) 50kg

(B) 55kg

(C) 60kg

(D) None

Q25. Five boxes A, B, C, D, E are placed one above another. A is 4th from bottom. B is immediately above A. C is at bottom. D is above B. E is between B and D? Let's simplify: E is between A and B. Which is at top?

(A) D

(B) B

(C) E

(D) C

Answer Key for Practice Questions

Q.No	Answer	Q.No	Answer	Q.No	Answer	Q.No	Answer
Q1	(C) C	Q8	(B) B	Q15	(C) T	Q22	(C) Phone
Q2	(D) S	Q9	(B) X	Q16	(B) 22	Q23	(A) Black
Q3	(B) Wednesday	Q10	(C) Nexon	Q17	(A) 2nd	Q24	(C) 60kg
Q4	(C) Green	Q11	(A) Cat	Q18	(C) Milk	Q25	(A) D
Q5	(C) Box 4	Q12	(A) January	Q19	(C) R	-	-
Q6	(B) 2nd	Q13	(C) 165cm	Q20	(C) David	-	-
Q7	(B) K	Q14	(B) Football	Q21	(B) Tuesday	-	-